welfare, Lok Sabha Unstarred Question No. 716 answered on 23 July 2021.

49. *India Today*, 'India Today Mood of the Nation Survey', August 2021, https://www.indiatoday.in/mood-of-the-nation-survey-august-2021.

50. The Indian economy in September 2020 was 'not yet past the 2019-20 figures in terms of actual, absolute levels of real GDP'. Union finance secretary T.V. Somanathan interview in 'We are pulling out of the worst … problem with stimulus is its easier to start a spending programme than to stop it', *The Indian Express,* Idea Exchange, 20 September 2021, p. 12.

51. Interview with Rajeev Chandrasekhar, BJP Rajya Sabha MP, 26 August 2019, New Delhi. Chandrasekhar was subsequently appointed, in July 2021, as Union minister of state for skills development and entrepreneurship as well as for electronics and information technology.

52. Collated from Anurag Singh Thakur, minister of state for finance, answer to Lok Sabha Unstarred Question No. 1183, 19 September 2020; P. Radhakrishnan, minister of state for finance, answer to Lok Sabha Unstarred Question No. 2827, 28 December 2018; cash and kind break-up of all 2017-18 and 2018-19 transfers from DBT Mission, Government of India, https://dbtbharat.gov.in/.

53. Quoted in PTI, 'Development only basis for politics now, women BJP's silent voters: PM', *Hindustan Times*, 12 November 2020, https://www.hindustantimes.com/india-news/development-only-basis-for-politics-now-women-bjp-s-silent-voters-pm-modi/story-SdrkdYS7gwhGEVBV9BI4FP.html.

54. Rathin Roy, 'It's not too late, but it could soon be', *Business Standard,* 7 August 2020, https://www.business-standard.com/article/opinion/it-is-not-too-late-but-it-soon-will-be-120080700063_1.html.

55. Idea Exchange with Viral Acharya, 'Can't make transfers to household in Covid because we haven't had an open debate on Fisc', *The Indian Express*, 10 August 2020. In September 2020, the government was 'at a budgeted deficit of 6.8%'. Idea Exchange with Union finance secretary T.V. Somanathan, 'We are